



Republic of the Philippines
Department of Education
SOCCSKSARGEN REGION

09 Sept 2026

REGIONAL MEMORANDUM

No. 100 s. 2026

2026 REGIONAL FESTIVAL OF TALENTS (RFOT)

To: Schools Division Superintendents
All Others Concerned

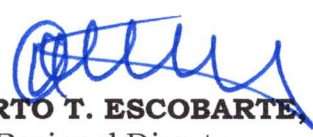
1. The Department of Education SOCCSKSARGEN Region shall conduct the **2026 Regional Festival of Talents (RFOT) on December 7-9, 2026, at Polomolok, South Cotabato.**
2. The 2026 Regional Festival of Talents aims to:
 - a. provide opportunities for learners from public and private elementary and secondary schools as well as those from the Alternative Learning System (ALS), Indigenous Peoples Education (IPED), Special Needs Education (SNEd), and Madrasah Education Program (MEP) to showcase their talents and skills;
 - b. strengthen teachers' and learners' knowledge and skill set as they listen to the invaluable insights by the panel of experts; and
 - c. application and transfer of learning from competencies mastered in the classroom to authentic and meaningful contexts.
3. Participants in the RFOT are learners from public and private elementary and secondary schools who will showcase their talents and skills at different events.
4. Participation in the 2026 RFOT is voluntary. It shall not, in any way, affect the time-on-task of teachers as this activity's target learning standard and competencies are already embedded in teachers' actual teaching and assessment process.
5. The events will be conducted in-person. To ensure the safety, health, and well-being of all the participants, strict observance of minimum health protocols and safety drills should be implemented.
6. All Schools Division Offices (SDOs) are hereby directed to conduct their respective division-level competitions and establish appropriate mechanisms for the selection of contestants who will represent their division at the regional level.
7. There shall only be one entry per event per division except Lingo Stars. The learner participant/s shall be certified by the school head as bona fide learners and officially enrolled for the year 2025-2026.
8. The Schools Division Offices (SDO) shall take care of their own provisions for contest materials, supplies, food, travel, and allowances of their participants, including their bedding. Participants shall wear plain white T-shirts without collar



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during the competition, except for Musabaqah participants where they can wear their Muslim attire.

9. A registration fee of One Thousand Pesos (Php 1,000.00) shall be charged to each participant and coach to cover certificates, medals, trophies, administrative expenses, honoraria, and the food and accommodation of judges. The food of delegates, to be managed by the Division, as well as transportation and other related expenses of participants, shall be charged against the School's Maintenance and Other Operating Expenses (MOOE), local or school Special Education Fund (SEF), School Campus Journalism Fund, or other available funds, subject to existing accounting and auditing rules and regulations. The deadline for Registration submission of names of RFOT qualifiers and payment at the Cashier's Office, DepEd SOCCSKSARGEN Regional Office, Carpenter Hill, City of Koronadal shall be on November 4, 2026.
10. To prepare for the said event, the Curriculum and Learning Management Division (CLMD) team will hold a coordination meeting with SDO South Cotabato Top Management and LGU on September 22, 2026, at 9:00 am at the Division Office of South Cotabato.
11. The RFOT guidelines are available on this link: <https://surli.cc/mqbjqy> for guidance and reference. **These guidelines shall remain subject to modification upon the issuance of updated guidelines by the Central Office (CO).**
12. For queries and clarifications, contact Ildefonso E. Libdan, Jr. EPS-CLMD through ildefonsojr.libdan@deped.gov.ph.
13. For information and guidance of all concerned.


ATTY. ALBERTO T. ESCOBARTE, CESO II
Regional Director

Encls.: As stated
References: None
Allotment: RFOT Current Funds
To be indicated in the Perpetual Index
under the following subjects:

CURRICULUM
PROGRAM

CONTESTS

IEL/CLMD/RM- REGIONAL FESTIVAL OF TALENTS (RFOT) 2026
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